



Vickers Medium Mark II

Introduced in 1923, the Vickers Medium tank was the first British tank to see service equipped with a sprung suspension and a rotating turret. The design was so successful that the Medium was the main British tank from 1923 to 1935.

DESIGNED TO FIGHT on the move, the Medium's high speed of 30 mph (48 km/h) came from its air-cooled Armstrong Siddeley engine, which was mounted in the front of the tank. The tank itself had seven variants. The first, the Medium Mark I, had a 3-pounder gun in the turret, a Vickers machine gun in each side of the hull, and Hotchkiss light machine guns in the turret. This main gun was adequate against contemporary tanks, but it was useless against field fortifications and antitank guns, so a close support version of the tank was built. The Mark II dispensed with the Hotchkiss machine guns and had a coaxial Vickers machine gun instead. In addition to the gun tanks, command-post and bridge-laying versions were also produced.

Vickers Mediums formed the backbone of the British Army's Experimental Mechanised Force of 1928. This revolutionary combat formation performed maneuvers on Salisbury Plain that showed the potential of mechanized formations. For this reason, the mechanization of the British Army continued through the 1930s.



REAR VIEW



SPECIFICATIONS	
Name	Tank, Medium, Mark II*
Date	1923
Origin	UK
Production	100
Engine	Armstrong Siddeley V8 gasoline, 90hp
Weight	13 tons (11.75 tonnes)
Main armament	3-pounder
Secondary armament	3 x Vickers .303 machine guns
Crew	5
Armor thickness	0.25-0.3 in (6.25-8 mm)

Diagram labels: Gunner, Gunner, Commander, Gunner, Driver